

lot about inheritances (and douchebags). I was pretty sure all I'd inherit was debt and some Native American art. (It's lovely, but my parents really gotta cut out buying dreamcatchers and turquoise. My childhood home is an ode to appropriation at this point.)

So here's the big Dunn family inheritance problem: When Pepe died, my grandmother was left \$2 million liquid. Over the next five years, she blew through half of that. What did Meme spend \$1 million on? "Stuff," my dad said in 2017. Makeup, rings, dresses, scarves, anti-aging creams. The twisted part is the longer she lives, the more time she has to spend that money, the less inheritance my dad and his sister get. And Meme, by her own admission, doesn't care.

What may seem cruel in print is just Meme's way. Because of what she went through during the war, our family rightfully cuts her a lot of slack on her enjoyment of life. Sometimes she says things that make you want to snuggle her, and then two seconds later, she says something else that makes you want to strangle her. She seems to be delighting in how tense her spending has made everyone. She's in charge now.

Luckily, my aunt and my dad are best friends. They've worked it out so that whatever inheritance they get, they split up in a way that makes sense, regardless of what Meme has put in her will. (No one narc to Meme! I'm trusting you guys.)

My sister, my brother, and I have our shares cut out for us, but I can't get a real number out of either Meme or my father. I probably won't until it comes time to actually handle her affairs. My brother has a wife and a kid. My sister and I are currently unmarried and both childless. I'd assume my brother and his family are getting more money. That just seems fair, but I'm only guessing.

Pepe wasn't a money factory to me; he was a human being who called me and my friends "good-looking tomatoes" and danced with me and my sister by letting us stand on his feet. He kept Snickers bars in the freezer because he liked to eat them that way as dessert, and he always seemed to be wearing a different very comfy sweater over a button-down shirt. I don't ever remember thinking, when we were at Pepe's funeral or even in the five years afterward, about what his money meant for us.